

PART 6: MONSTERS

Any creature that is not a player character is called a monster. Monsters may be friendly or unfriendly, wild or tame, normal beasts or fantastic. The DM will choose, from these monsters, the friends and opponents of the players.

The monsters are listed in alphabetical order to aid quick reference. Other monsters can be found in the D&D® EXPERT rules and in the D&D® COMPANION supplement rules. The monsters in this section and their abilities are of the strength and type most commonly encountered. The DM may wish to make these monsters stronger or weaker to suit the needs of the campaign. When adjusting the strength of a monster, the DM must also adjust the other abilities, such as Armor Class, Move, Damage, and Saves so that they balance with the monster's adjusted hit dice. The DM may also create other monsters after becoming familiar with the monsters in this booklet, perhaps basing such monsters on creatures the DM has read about in works of fantasy or science fiction.

Some of the monsters names are followed by an *asterisk* (*). This means that magic and special or magic weapons are necessary to fight the monster. It is recommended that these monsters be used with caution.

All non-human monsters have infravision (heat-sensing sight) and may "see" objects by their heat up to 60' away in the dark. Hot objects appear as white shapes, warm objects are varying shades of grey and cold objects are black. Living creatures can be seen by their body heat. Fire or large sources of heat tend to mess up infravision.

The **Armor Class (AC)** of each monster is given as a number similar to the AC of characters. The number is based on both the toughness of a monster's skin or clothing and on the monster's speed and dexterity.

Hit Dice gives the number of eight-sided dice (d8) to be used to determine a monster's hit points, as well as any adjustments to the hit points (+ or -). **EXAMPLE:** To determine the hit points of a monster with 3 + 1 hit dice, roll 3d8 and add 1 to the total. **The DM will always use eight-sided dice to find a monster's hit points.**

"Hit dice" also gives the level of the monster and the dungeon level on which it is most commonly found. In general, a monster's level equals its number of hit dice, ignoring any pluses or minuses. **EXAMPLE:** A monster with 3 + 1 hit dice is a third level monster, and is most commonly found on the 3rd level of any dungeon. **Note:** if a monster has several special powers, the DM may consider it one level greater than its hit dice.

A monster's level is only a guide, and a monster could be found anywhere in a dungeon, whatever the level. However, as a general rule, it is useful to limit monsters to 2 dungeon levels higher or lower than their hit dice. When monsters are encountered on dungeon levels less than the monsters' level, there should be fewer monsters than normal. And when monsters are met on dungeon levels greater than the monsters' level, there should be more monsters than normal. **EXAMPLE:** A 4th level monster might be found anywhere in dungeon levels 2 through 6, but it is not likely to be found on the 1st or 7th levels except one at a time (on the 1st level) or in large numbers (on the 7th level or below).

"Hit dice" also determine both the chances of a monster's attack being successful and the number of experience points a character will get for defeating it. The **Monster Attacks** table and the **Experience Points for Monsters** table are both arranged by the

monster's hit dice. In each monster description, an *asterisk* (*) after the hit dice means that the *special abilities bonus* should be added when the DM gives out experience points. *Two asterisks* means that the special abilities bonus should be *added twice* when the DM gives experience points.

Move (or **movement rate**) gives the number of feet a monster may move in one *turn*. The number in parentheses is the number of feet a monster may move in one *round* of combat. Both numbers are usually written with a mark to indicate feet (for example, 20' means twenty feet). Some monsters will have two movement rates; the first rate is the speed of the monster when walking, and the second rate is a special form of movement such as swimming, flying or climbing.

Attacks gives the number and type of attacks which the monster may make in one round. **Damage** gives a range of points of damage caused if the monster's attacks are successful. When a monster can make several attacks in one *round*, the attacks and damages are given in the same order. **EXAMPLE:** "Attacks: 2 claws/1 bite; Damage: 1-4/1-4/2-12" means that the monster's claw attacks may each do 1-4 (1d4) points of damage, and the bite may cause 2-12 points (2d6) points of damage if successful. Some notes on special attacks follow:

Poison: Poison is the bane of all characters. If a character is hit with a poisoned attack and misses his or her saving throw vs. Poison, the character will usually die. (Note: In the D&D EXPERT rules, there is a magical way to cure a poisoned creature.)

Paralysis: Paralysis is less dangerous than poison. When a character is hit by a paralyzing attack and that character misses his or her saving throw versus Paralysis, the character is "frozen" and unable to do anything, but is not dead. The character remains fully aware of things happening in the area, but is unable to do anything that requires movement (speaking, spell casting, and so forth) until the paralysis wears off. Unless otherwise stated, paralysis will last for 2-8 (2d4) turns. A **cure light wounds** cleric spell will remove paralysis, but will not cure any damage when used for this purpose. Any attacks on a paralyzed creature will automatically hit (only a roll for damage is necessary). Paralysis itself has no permanent effects of any kind.

Energy drain: A successful hit by a wight will drain energy from the victim. Unlike other special attacks, there is no saving throw against an energy drain. Each energy drain will destroy one level of experience of a character, or one hit die of a monster. The creature drained of energy loses all the benefits (attack level, saving throws, spells, etc.) of the former level. This effect cannot be cured. (Note: In the D&D COMPANION supplement, there is a magical way to cure energy drains.)

Charm: A character who fails to save vs. Spells against a charm attack (such as from a harpy) is unable to make any decisions. A charmed character will be unable to attack or harm the charming monster in any way, and will obey simple commands the monster makes, if understood (if the monster speaks Common or if the character can understand the monster's language). If a charmed character cannot understand a monster, he or she will try to keep that monster safe from harm. Charmed characters are too confused to use any spells or magic items. The death of the charming monster will usually break this type of charm. (A charm may be magically dispelled.)

Acid: This is a special attack used by gray oozes and ochre jellies. A hit scored against the character's Armor Class means that the acid has reached the skin. The acid damage will be determined (no longer needing a roll "to hit") for as long as the character stays in contact with the monster, and until the acid is washed off (with water or wine). Acid attacks will destroy armor in a